



THE ROAD
TEMPLATES & WORKBOOKS



Scan the code for more workbooks

Questions To Ask Before You Hire a Defense Attorney

The right questions, before you sign anything or pay a retainer.

Choosing a lawyer is one of the most important decisions you will make, and most people make it scared and in a hurry. Bring this list to every consultation. A good attorney will welcome these questions. Anyone who brushes them off is telling you something.

Do not put the facts of your case in a voicemail or email while you are shopping for a lawyer. Save the details for a private conversation once you have chosen.

About their experience

- ☐ Have you handled cases like mine specifically, in this court?
- ☐ How many of these cases have you taken to trial, and what happened?
- ☐ Will you personally handle my case, or will it be passed to someone else?
- ☐ Do you regularly appear before the judge and prosecutors in this jurisdiction?

About the money

- ☐ What is your fee, and exactly what does it cover?
- ☐ Is it a flat fee or hourly? What happens if the case goes to trial?
- ☐ What costs are extra: experts, investigators, filing fees?
- ☐ Is any part of the retainer refundable? Do you offer a payment plan?

About strategy and communication

- ☐ Based on what you know so far, what are the possible outcomes?
- ☐ What is your honest read on the strengths and weaknesses of my case?
- ☐ How and how often will you update me?
- ☐ Who do I call with questions, and how fast do you respond?
- ☐ What do you need from me, and by when?

Trust your read

- Beware anyone who guarantees a result. No honest lawyer can.
- Beware pressure to sign immediately. A real professional lets you think.
- You are allowed to consult more than one attorney before deciding.
- Fit and experience in your kind of case matter more than price alone.

Notes from each consultation

Attorney name: _____

Fee and what it covers:

My gut read:

This workbook is educational and reflects lived and professional experience. It is not legal advice and does not create an attorney-client relationship. Laws and procedures vary by jurisdiction and change over time. For advice about your situation, consult a licensed attorney in your state.

More free tools and guidance: hub.newphysician.org/templates · bustedbythefed.com · whitecollaracademy.com

The Road · Templates & Workbooks